

Unit 1- Scramble for Africa

Part 1- North Africa

1882- Britain invaded Egypt

1-Ottoman Empire

2-Suez Canal (1869)

3-Investment

4-Diplomatic necessities

1. The Ottoman Empire

•Egypt was the biggest most important asset under the Ottoman Empire, a protectorate, although it was very independent.

•Egypt was important as an overland route, GB's biggest asset was India known as the 'jewel in the crown' (economically valuable).

- It was Britain's policy to prop up, support the Ottoman Empire; they did not want the Ottoman Empire to collapse as they wanted to keep the balance of power in their favour as Britain was at the top. If there was to be a benefit they wanted it to be for them. **Britain did not want Russia and France to benefit from Ottoman weakness.**
- **1877-1878:** war between Turkey and Russia, Britain supported the Turkish as they didn't want Russia to win. In return Britain got Cyprus; Britain needed to secure their route to Egypt army bases.

2. The Suez Canal - French company built it using Egyptian labour

(Proposed by Ferdinand de Lesseps)

- Talked about for 2000 years
- Built by the Egyptians and French
- Proposed by French man Ferdinand de Lesseps

British control over the Suez Canal was the last thing the British wanted because it was expensive and it would make the French really rich. Also in time of war it could be used against her, even though it would make travel easier.

Steam ships replaced sailing boats as they were more efficient/reliable and the wind was unnecessary which was good as no wind in the canal, therefore the canal increased in importance.

***1870-**436,609 tonnes of freight went through

***1882-**5,074,809

***1914-**20,000,000

Britain could not risk Egypt falling into someone else's hands.

1880- Egypt was becoming less well kept, accessible

In **1849** Mehmet Ali and was replaced by Saied who died in **1863**, Egypt was peaceful and well off for 3 years. Said was not much of a businessman, he gave the French allowance to build the canal in order to boost the economy and sold the Egyptian business for the canal.

- they offered peasant farmers to move for free, work on canal for free

- Egypt got 45% ownership and the other 55% went to a French company which also stated they had no voting rights for decisions.

1863-1879- Saied was replaced by Ismail. Ismail was now the Egyptian leader. He wanted to make Egypt a player in the world, independence of turkey (destabilise Ottoman Empire) and modernise the economy. He spent a fortune on all of this but Egypt didn't have the money to waste and this put Egypt far into debt.

3. Investment

Egyptians sold lots of stuff, economy was solid:

- economy boomed

- cultivable land increased by $\frac{1}{3}$

- 1000 miles of railway

- irrigation canals

- Alexandria became a very valuable port

Egypt didn't have the capital to undertake all these improvements and therefore borrowed money. There were low interest rates due to economic boom in Europe, the banks had so much money and they needed people to borrow it and Egypt did.

A massive boom in the British economy had occurred in the 1800's, so there were very low interest rates and they were desperate to invest it.

1875- They borrowed more than they could. They paid 29 million pounds which was principle (initial amount borrowed) + interest. The Egyptians didn't have enough to pay back and made a complete mess. Egypt about to become bankrupt especially if they are trying to attract investment. Therefore they turned to French banks and questionable individuals.

Egypt was in great debt, literally bankrupt. Many British banks were scared of Egypt losing everything as they would lose all the money they loaned to Egypt.

1875 Benjamin Disraeli- British prime minister bought 44% of the Suez Canal for national security and didn't ask the parliament because the prime minister could act without asking the parliament in times of emergency.

Ismail- was desperate to sell the shares of the Suez Canal to the French. The French already owned 55% with profit and voting rights and Egypt had 45% which didn't include voting rights or profits. To salvage this from happening Rothschild's bank helped Disraeli to buy the shares of the canal (44%). Rothschild did this for national security to avoid French taking it. Egypt was still on the verge of collapsing.

The 44% that Disraeli bought had no votes, as earlier Ismail sold voting rights to France, so France had 100% of the votes.

Disraeli presented the canal to Queen Victoria and the British people had a stronger feeling of owning the canal.

1875- Ismail asked Britain and France for help in Egypt, Britain sent treasury master, Steven Cave who went to see what was happening in Egypt, even though Egypt should have turned to the Ottoman Empire who had control of Egypt but the Ottoman Empire had no idea about finances and could not really control Egypt. Britain and France on the other hand were well aware of dealing with money and banks.

4. Diplomatic necessities

Stephen Cave's report said: poor management, overspending and rising rates are at the heart of the problem. But if Egypt were run correctly there would be no reason why Egypt wouldn't succeed. Egypt should be run by Europeans (more efficient, less corrupt)

1878- Dual Control Financial Plan

An Anglo-French rescue plan to help Egypt after British and French reports. The French aim was to reduce spending in Egypt (French sent Joubert = gov. official). British bankers increased revenue, but didn't want gov to be directly involved.

- Reduce spending
- Cut in interest rate
- Lowering pay for the government officials, army, police by reducing salaries
- Increased revenue by increased taxes, very successful, sorted out the Egyptian finances (they weren't happy). Also from 1878-9 good harvest which also helped economy (part of prob = bad harvest in 1876)

It was successful as they sorted out Egyptian finances however....

Army was very unhappy and unemployment increased significantly.

February 1879- FIRST MUTINY (crushed quickly) started by Ismail himself to force out Europeans as they had already fixed their problem and given them good ideas- no longer needed.

-The mutiny was crushed by the Ottoman Empire and the British, the sultan forced Ismail to leave but the French and British wanted him back as he was easy to control, so he regained his title.

However, by the end of 1879, Ismail was dismissed and replaced by Tewfik (Sultan never regained trust in Ismail). The Europeans were happy with this as they believed Tewfik would be even easier to control than Ismail.

Nationalism and Arabi Pasha

Nationalist movement→end to the Turkish control in Egypt

→ Egypt for the Egyptians

→ End to foreign involvement

1882

January- British and the French sent a note to Tewfik saying they would support him if there was any unrest (there had been unrest such as strikes, protests) - *the beginning of socialism???* However the Egyptian nationalist and the army looked at the note with suspicion because the French had done the same the year before to Tunisia in North Africa, and then took over. They saw it as an excuse to take control of Egypt, '*this note was like lighting a candle in a field full of minds*'. That note angered the Egyptians very much as they were already stressed by their country's condition.

February- the new prime minister of Egypt was Mahmond Pasha Sami was very sympathetic towards the Egyptian nationalists. He included Arabi Pasha in his cabinet who was the leader of the mutiny. Tension started to build and the British felt it was a dangerous situation because it might affect the Suez Canal. France also believed this.

June- Britain sent warships to Alexandria to evacuate refugees; they probably did this to threaten and scare the Egyptians however it had no effect on the Egyptians. On the 11th of June there was a **Riot in Alexandria** which was the direct response to the warships and about 50 Europeans were killed including 3 British sailors. The British believed that Arabi Pasha and the army started the riot.

July- exactly one month later on the 11th, in response to the riot the British bombarded the brand new defence base in Alexandria, which was completely destroyed. (they believed it was a military issue)

After the war started...

Arabi's army was camped outside and besieged Alexandria cut all water supplies as a response to July 11th. The British believed the Suez Canal was under threat. The British turned to the s

Sultan for help, but he was not interested in helping them. There was very little opposition and a few religious politicians quit, Some Brit. politicians resigned from the government in opposition to the invasion (said it would threaten the security of the Suez Canal.)

-Britain didn't want to invade by itself, so they turned to Bismarck, publicly he was trying to get Britain and France to work together but privately was encouraging Britain to intervene in order to split up Britain and France.

August 1882

Britain on her own intervened militarily in Egypt; they were led by Tewfik, they asked him to help put down the rebellious army. They took control within a month. First thing they took control of was the canal (within 3 days).

Arabi Pasha was captured and exiled as well as other military leaders.

Attacked with the intention of freeing that country from going into tyranny of a military dictatorship, to protect British people, economy and economic assets).

Britain wanted to invade quickly and then get out for economic safety, Gladstone announced

'We have done our Egyptian business, we are the Egyptian government'

After the intervention in Egypt in 1882, Gladstone said all they wanted was to get in do their business and get out but they couldn't just leave as Egypt didn't have a steady government and was being run by army nationalists.

Gladstone got elected by promising he would not get involved in other continents but still interfered in Africa.

(Egypt was not a colony but a protectorate, there were more and more neighbours making it more threatening, therefore needed to protect its empire)

Sudan

The Sudan was the south border of Egypt. Egypt had strong influence in the Sudan and almost had total control over the government in Sudan.

-the nationalist's movement led by the Mahdi (religious leader) wanted the Egyptians out of the Sudan, just like the British.

-British worried that the problems of the Sudan, like the Nile, drained into Egypt

British told Egypt to not get involved in Sudan as they didn't want Sudan problems flooding into Egypt and did not themselves want to get involved in the Sudan. BUT when in charge of Egypt, Sudan WAS GB problem. Threat to the Nile.

- Gladstone sent General Gordon to the Sudan to help the Egyptians evacuate. Gordon told do whatever was necessary, anything to withdraw them efficiently and safely.

-Gordon decided that what they were doing was wrong and refused the orders they were given believing they were morally wrong.

- Gladstone delayed reinforcements that Gordon had asked for and by the time he had decided to send them Gordon, the army and some Egyptians had already been killed by the Mahdi.

Gordon's death made people criticise Gladstone (1) supporters of Empire accuse Gladstone of not being strong enough to send Gordon more troops and (2), those opposed to Empire criticised Gladstone for getting involved in Africa in the first place.

Britain now had to throw more of its military into Egypt, as allowing Egypt to collapse risked all those millions of loans.

The Fashoda Incident and the Battle of Omdurman

Fashoda

The French wanted to control land from the East coast to the West coast including control of the headwaters of the Nile.

The British wanted to establish a railway from the Cape of Good Hope to Cairo, a north-to-south railway, through the entire length of the continent. This led to the confrontation at Fashoda, over an obscure outpost, sought by no general staff.

The French foreign minister, Gabriel Hanotaux, in his attempts to continue French imperialism, sent an expedition of 150 men east to Gabon under Jean-Baptiste Marchand.

British forces, too, approached this area, under Sir Herbert Kitchener. Kitchener was looking to reconquer the Sudan (had been planning for it since 1885!!).

Marchand arrived at Fashoda on July 10, 1898, where he occupied the fort. Kitchener was held up at Omdurman and Khartoum, so his forces did not reach Fashoda for another two months, September 18, 1898.

With both armies wishing to occupy the fort at Fashoda, Kitchener and Marchand agreed that they did not want a military entanglement.

Theophile Delcasse, the new French foreign minister, wanted Britain's support against Germany. So, against public opinion, he decided to concede at Fashoda.

On November 4, 1898, Delcasse instructed Marchand to withdraw from Fashoda.

France wanted small forts to link French land in East and West, GB rejected plan

March 21, 1899, the French and British governments agreed that the watershed of the Nile and the Congo = boundaries between spheres of influence.

Improved relations after Fashoda led to the 1904 Anglo-French Entente.

Omdurman

In 1885 the Conservatives began contemplating how to retake power in Sudan.

In 1895, the British consul-general of Egypt, Sir Evelyn Baring finally convinced Salisbury's government to take action to prevent foreign powers from entering the area.

Salisbury gave permission for Cromer to begin planning the reconquest of Sudan, but all actions were to appear to take place under Egyptian authority. Colonel Kitchener was appointed commander in chief (of the Egyptian army)

1896, 18,000 advanced up the Nile slowly.

Kitchener began building the Sudan Military Railroad (200km into the desert) completed October 1897. Gov sent 8000 British troops and gunboats to join Kitchener.

April 1898 battle of Atara = bad defeat for 14000 Mahdists sent to attack Kitchener's army.

Mahdists retreated to Omdurman and raised over 50,000 (armed with antique rifles and spears)

1 September gunboats shelled Omdurman

2 September @ dawn Mahdists attacked

by 11am they were defeated (not without some difficulties, but relatively easily)

10,000 Mahdists died, 13,000 were injured & 5000 were captured

47 British/Egyptians died & 340 injured

Khartoum was taken soon after and Kitchener moved South to Fashoda to block the French (which led to the Fashoda incident).